Marcos Javier Alvarez

Principal Engineer · Production LLM platforms in regulated lending · Evaluations, provider failover, cost tracing · TypeScript, Node.js, AWS

Cúcuta, Colombia (Remote) · UTC-5, US-hours overlap · garusis@gmail.com · github.com/garusis · linkedin.com/in/garusis

Portfolio, references and a queryable MCP endpoint: hire-me-mcp-web.vercel.app · **Query it from any MCP client:** hire-me-mcp-web.vercel.app/api/mcp

Summary

I build production LLM platforms for regulated mortgage lending. I spent 4.5 years as Staff Engineer at House Numbers, one of its first two non-founding engineers, as the team grew from three to seven. I built its LLM evaluation, provider-failover and deterministic-validation layers. When Dark Matter Technologies acquired the House Numbers platform and team, I joined as Principal Engineer.

Experience

Dark Matter Technologies — Principal Engineer · Nov 2026 – Present

- Joined with the House Numbers engineering team after Dark Matter acquired its AI agent platform and IP in October 2026.

House Numbers — Staff Engineer · May 2022 – Oct 2026

- Built and owned the communications service, keeping LLM classification separate from deterministic routing. It let operations retire manual-triage shifts and handled 57,000+ communications in a seven-month window.
- Moved LLM infrastructure for four services off a vendor platform into an in-house layer with versioned prompts, provider failover, per-call cost tracing and evaluations.
- Led the document-extraction evaluation audit and wrote its methodology (ground truth from printed values, exact matching, a hash-locked answer key), giving the team a reproducible baseline for under $10 across three runs.
- Moved document checks from LLM generation to deterministic, tested validation, so loan processors get reproducible results.
- Rebuilt routing for the public borrower document-upload flow, resolving recurring failed-upload complaints.
- Wrote the engineering guide to handling PII in agent systems, later used to shape the company's data-retention and deletion work.

Tech: TypeScript, Node.js, React, MongoDB, AWS ECS, Redis, Kubernetes, OpenAI API, Anthropic API, New Relic, Zod.

Xogito Group — Senior Software Development Engineer · Dec 2020 – Mar 2022

- First engineer assigned to, then main backend engineer of, a multi-tenant SaaS for real-time quality-control inspections (NestJS, TypeScript, PostgreSQL, AWS, GitLab CI); owned backend architecture and delivery end to end.
- Recovered a frustrated client's account after the project manager resigned: became the team's spokesperson, paired quick wins with core-workflow repairs, rebuilt trust within a few sprints and led the client product conversations for about six months; the client went on to commission additional projects.
- Onboarded and mentored new engineers with an approach later adopted at House Numbers as a rotating buddy program; 15+ people onboarded across the two companies.
- Led the platform's legacy-SAP data migration: evaluated ETL tooling, built custom scripts where existing tools could not represent the source and target models, validated rounding compatibility early with platform users, and needed no post-migration reconciliation.

Tech: NestJS, TypeScript, PostgreSQL, Docker, GitLab CI, AWS.

FullStack Labs — Senior Software Engineer · Dec 2018 – Dec 2020

- Full-stack engineer (Node.js, React, PostgreSQL) on a procurement platform rebuilt for a US fiduciary purchasing agent (FF&E/OS&E).
- Owned the migration of historical quote data out of a legacy SAP system with zero data loss: custom ETL, traced a financial-total discrepancy to SAP/JavaScript rounding differences, and ran a frozen cutover with snapshot-backed reconciliation; users retired the legacy system after MVP launch.

Tech: Node.js, React, PostgreSQL, AWS, Docker.

Earlier Experience

Belatrix Software — Senior NodeJS Software Developer · Jul 2018 – Nov 2018

- Acting technical lead: serverless architecture (Lambda, CloudFormation, DynamoDB) for a dynamic-document platform; led a four-person team delivering it.

Rokk3r — Senior Full Stack Developer and DevOps · Feb 2016 – Jun 2018

- Via Kubesoft SAS: migrated a real-time telecom monolith to an AWS Kubernetes microservices cluster; migrated a mobile backend off Parse ahead of its shutdown deadline.

Kubesoft SAS — Senior Full Stack & Mobile Developer · Jan 2015 – Jun 2018

- Web/hybrid-mobile products for Colombian and international clients; built the first backend of Mutual, a hackathon-winning parenting app. From Feb 2016 assigned full-time to Rokk3r (above).

Jarvi Games — Full Stack Developer and DevOps · Feb 2013 – Jun 2015

- Real-time game backend with micropayments (Node.js, MongoDB, PostgreSQL, PHP) and its infrastructure.

Selected Projects

hire-me-mcp — Creator and maintainer · github.com/garusis/hire-me-mcp · hire-me-mcp-web.vercel.app

- Public MCP server, RAG-backed interview agent (Neon pgvector, Gemini embeddings) and Next.js site over one typed career dataset; Vitest, Playwright e2e against real Vercel previews, and retrieval/agent evals as required CI gates.

cowork — Creator and maintainer · github.com/garusis/cowork

- Open-source Python CLI that orchestrates multiple AI coding agents into role-based teams, with phase gates, per-role evals and cost reporting.

Skills

- **AI / LLM Engineering:** OpenAI API, Anthropic API, LLMs (Large Language Models), LLM Evaluation (human-graded, LLM-as-judge), AI Agents, Prompt Engineering, Document AI (OCR/vision-LLM), MCP (Model Context Protocol), RAG (Retrieval-Augmented Generation).
- **Languages:** TypeScript, JavaScript, SQL.
- **Frontend:** React, Next.js.
- **Backend:** Node.js, NestJS, Microservices, Event-Driven Architecture, REST APIs, Webhooks.
- **Data:** MongoDB, PostgreSQL, Redis, pgvector.
- **Cloud & Infrastructure:** AWS, AWS ECS, Docker, Kubernetes, Serverless (Lambda/CloudFormation), GitLab CI, GitHub Actions, Vercel, New Relic.
- **Practices:** CI/CD, Observability, Turborepo/pnpm monorepos, Mentoring & Onboarding, PII handling and field-level encryption, Playwright, Vitest, Zod, ETL / Data Migration.

Education

- Universidad Nacional Abierta y a Distancia (UNAD) — coursework toward B.S. Systems Engineering